

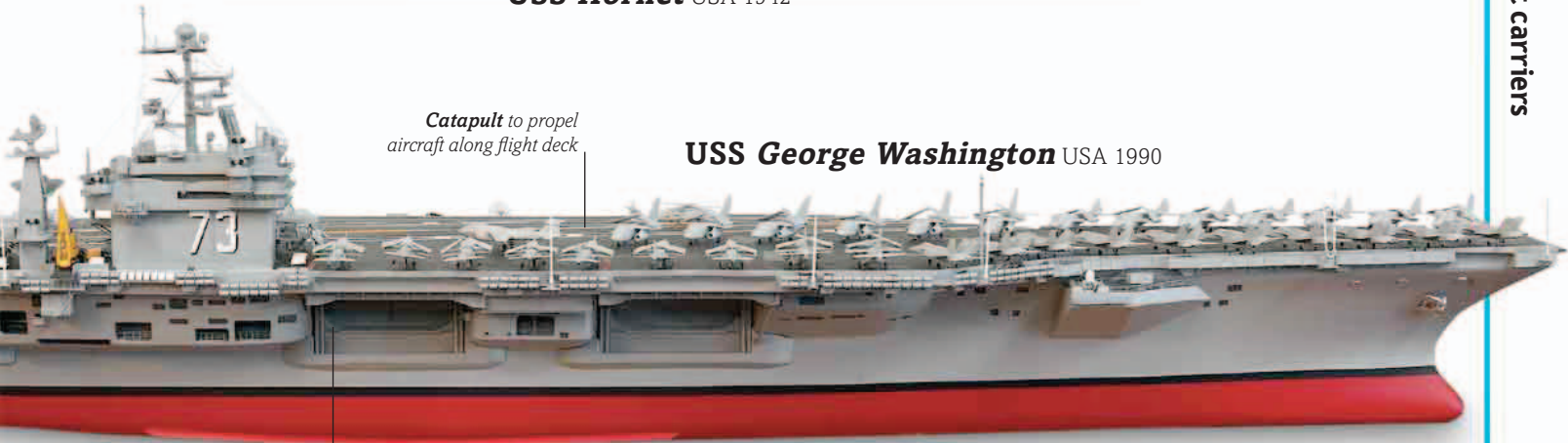


Aircraft launched from bow of ship using two powerful catapults

Radio antennae enables communication between ship and its flying aircraft

USS Hornet USA 1942

873 ft (266 m) long



Catapult to propel aircraft along flight deck

USS George Washington USA 1990

1,093 ft (333 m) long

Elevator for moving aircraft from below decks to the flight deck

Ship can carry 30 helicopters or around 12 helicopters and 12 Harrier aircraft

Ski jump ramp to assist aircraft takeoff

Biplane bombers amongst the maximum 78 aircraft onboard

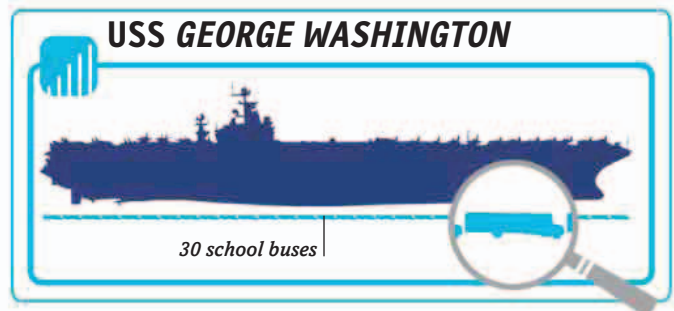


Juan Carlos I Spain 2003

757 ft (230.8 m) long

Crane raised and lowered boats into and out of the water

Propellers give a speed of 35 mph (56 km/h)



USS GEORGE WASHINGTON

30 school buses

built aircraft carriers, such as **HMS Illustrious** and the **USS Hornet**, featured catapults powered by hydraulics or steam to propel the aircraft on takeoff, as well as hangers below the flight deck to store inactive planes. Aircraft carriers have large crews—1,580 in the case of

HMS Ark Royal. However, this figure is dwarfed by the more than 6,000 who serve aboard the Nimitz Class carrier, **USS George Washington**. This 97,003-ton ship holds up to 90 aircraft of varying types, from reconnaissance planes and helicopters to fighters and bombers.